

sider an example: the principal of an institute wants to release the results of a recently conducted test, and fast—everything's already overdue. There is a tremendous amount of data to be compiled. Conventional office suites would require one person like a data entry operator to key in the marks of each student for each subject—this can be time consuming. It is in situations such as these that online office suites come in handy. They can be time-saving in data segregation from multiple sources. The easiest way would be to start a Google Document session. She could then invite the teachers as collaborators, who would enter the marks in the respective fields. At the end she could invite all the students as viewers.

The next important function on Google Docs is Publish. Clicking on this gives the document a unique URL, whereby anyone can view it.

Google Docs also empowers you with the option of publishing your document right away as a blog! This gives a reasonably brief idea of using Google documents, the first alternative to the typical MS Word processor. One must note that this is in fact just the tip of the iceberg. Let us analyse another tool by Google which would serve as an alternative to MS Excel.

1.1.2 Google Spreadsheets

Spreadsheets have literally been controlling our lives for long. Either directly or indirectly, we have all been associated and affected by them. Project management, budget and resource allocation, attendance sheets, payrolls, household expenses... spreadsheets are inevitable. Besides, the numerous formulae incorporated into professional spreadsheets that have made the lives of those who use them a lot easier all this while, are now difficult to do away with. Now picture this. Your spreadsheet is shared among a team, with each team member entering data fields relevant to him / her. This would significantly expedite the time required for updating data. Similar to Google documents, you need to get to the Google Docs homepage with your Google account.

In the same way that we started off with Google Documents, go to New > Spreadsheets to begin.

The toolbar resembles that of MS Excel, with slight differences.